

Sentinel 3D — Getting Started

3D security site planning · installation, activation and first steps · version 4.0.0

1. System requirements

	Minimum	Recommended
Operating system	Windows 10 (64-bit) or macOS 11 Big Sur	Windows 11, or macOS 13 Ventura or later
Processor	Intel Core i5 / AMD Ryzen 5 (2016 or newer), or Apple M1	Intel Core i7 / AMD Ryzen 7, or Apple M2 or newer
Memory (RAM)	8 GB	16 GB or more
Graphics	Built-in graphics with WebGL 2 (Intel UHD 620, AMD Vega, Apple M1)	Dedicated graphics with 4 GB (NVIDIA GTX 1650 / RTX, AMD RX 6000) or Apple M-series
Screen	1366 × 768	1920 × 1080 or larger
Free disk space	1 GB	5 GB on an SSD (room for projects and aerial photos)
Internet	Not needed to use the software	Only for updates; nothing else ever goes online
Input	Mouse or trackpad	Mouse with scroll wheel

Large sites with many buildings, the “3 views” comparison and **High quality** shadows need the recommended graphics. On older computers choose **Settings → Picture quality → Fast (older devices)**.

2. Install on Windows

1. Download **Sentinel-3D-Setup-x.x.x.exe** from the link your supplier gave you.
2. Double-click it. If Windows shows “Windows protected your PC”, click **More info → Run anyway**. (This appears because the installer is new to Windows, not because anything is wrong.)
3. Read and accept the licence agreement.
4. Choose **who to install for** and the **folder** (the suggested folder is fine), then click **Install**.
5. Leave **Run Sentinel 3D** ticked and click **Finish**. A desktop shortcut and a Start-menu entry are created.

3. Install on a Mac

1. Download **Sentinel-3D-x.x.x-mac.dmg** and double-click it.

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2. Drag the **Sentinel 3D** icon onto the **Applications** folder, then eject the disk image.
3. The first time only: open **Applications**, **right-click** Sentinel 3D and choose **Open**, then **Open** again.
4. If macOS says it cannot verify the app: open **System Settings → Privacy & Security**, scroll down and click **Open Anyway** next to Sentinel 3D.

4. Activate with your licence key

Sentinel 3D works only after it is activated. **Each licence key works on one computer only.**

1. Open Sentinel 3D. The **Product Activation** screen shows your **Machine Code** (for example `TNXL-BY89-STSD-9CXS-5EZH-3B`).
2. Press **Copy** and send the code to your supplier by WhatsApp or email.
3. You receive a licence key (a long line starting with `S3D1.`) or a `.s3dkey` file.
4. Paste the whole key into the box — or press **Open key file…** — and press **Activate**.
5. Press **Start Sentinel 3D**. You will not be asked again on this computer.

Message	What to do
“This key was made for a different computer”	Send the Machine Code shown on this computer to your supplier.
“This key is not genuine, or part of it is missing”	Copy the whole key again — every character, from S3D1. to the end.
“This licence has expired”	Contact your supplier for a renewal key. Your projects are kept safe.
“The computer’s date appears to have been set back”	Correct the date and time in your computer settings.
New computer, or Windows/macOS reinstalled	The Machine Code changes. Ask your supplier for a new key.

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5. Your first project

1. On the start screen choose **New project**. Give it a name and the site's width and depth in metres.
2. Optional: add a **background photo from above** (drone or satellite picture) so you can trace the real site.
3. Use the **Build** tab or the **Add** panel to place buildings, walls, roads, gates, posts, cameras, lights, barriers and threats. Drag things to move them; use the handles to turn and resize.
4. Use the **Security** and **Analyse** tabs for camera coverage, blind spots, weapon and observation arcs, dead ground, night lighting, response times and the security report.
5. Press **Save** (Ctrl+S / ⌘S). Use **Help → Guided tour** for a walk through every feature.

6. Keep your work protected

- **Sign-in protection** (Settings → Security): every saved project on the computer is encrypted (AES-256). Nobody can open them without signing in.
- **Users and roles**: the Administrator adds people as **Planner** (build, save, export, print) or **Viewer** (look only). The **Activity log** records who signed in, saved, exported, printed or deleted, and failed sign-in attempts.
- **Touch ID** (Macs with a fingerprint sensor) and a **PIN** give quick unlock; your password always works too. Five wrong PINs switch the PIN off.
- **Auto-lock** after a set idle time, and **Lock now** when you step away.
- **Protected project files (.s3d)**: send a project to someone else encrypted with its own password.

If a password is forgotten, encrypted projects **cannot be recovered** — not even by the supplier. Another Administrator can set a new password for a user. Keep exported backups.

7. Backups

- Use **File → Export to a file** (or **Export protected file**) regularly and keep copies on a USB drive or another computer.
- Projects are stored inside your user account on this computer. Uninstalling the app does **not** delete them.
- **Versions** keeps earlier saved states of each project so you can compare or go back.

8. Updates

- **Windows**: when the computer is online, Sentinel 3D downloads updates in the background and asks to restart. Save your work and press **Restart and update now**.
- **Mac**: choose **Sentinel 3D → Check for Updates…**. The download page opens; replace the app in Applications with the new one. Your projects and licence are kept.

9. Uninstall

- **Windows**: Settings → Apps → Sentinel 3D → Uninstall.
- **Mac**: drag Sentinel 3D from Applications to the Bin.
- Your licence stays on the computer, so reinstalling on the same computer does not need a new key.

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10. If something goes wrong

Problem	Try this
3D view is blank, black or very slow	Update the graphics driver. Choose Settings → Picture quality → Fast (older devices). Close other heavy programs.
Buttons or labels look cut off	Make the window larger, or use View → Panels to hide the side panels.
Windows SmartScreen or macOS blocks the app	See sections 2 and 3: “More info → Run anyway”, or “Privacy & Security → Open Anyway”.
Forgot the sign-in password	Ask another Administrator to set a new one. Otherwise use “Forgot the password?” to erase and start again (exported files are not affected).
Anything else	Contact your supplier with the version number (Help → About) and your Licence number (Settings → Licence).

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